

Christopher Dillon, PhD

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Global Lead Data Scientist with 8+ years' experience spanning analytics, engineering, and advanced modelling. Proven track record of building data functions from scratch, including data warehouses, reporting suites, and self-service dashboards. Currently leading the data function of the Global Finance & Data Analytics Department at Nexus Brands Group, a portfolio of 18 international businesses in tattoo, beauty, and pet grooming supply across e-commerce and wholesale. Skilled in unifying fragmented systems, driving KPI strategy, and embedding a data-driven culture across businesses.

EXPERIENCE

Nexus Brands Group, Ballymoney — *Global Lead Data Scientist*

Key role in the formation of the Global Finance & Data Analytics Department, centralizing finance and data operations across **18 international businesses in tattoo, beauty, and pet grooming supply (e-commerce and wholesale)** to elevate decision-making and drive operational efficiency.

- **Team Leadership:** Lead and manage a global data team delivering insights to senior leadership.
- **Standardization:** Designed and implemented a universal data/reporting architecture to replace fragmented legacy systems.
- **Self-Service Analytics:** Built secure Streamlit dashboards with SAML-based authentication.
- **Operational Reporting:** Delivered supply chain reporting suites covering OTIF, E&O, and OOS. Implemented tracking that drove a 25% OTIF improvement, identified millions in excess and obsolete stock, and enabled the business to detect and reduce OOS-related sales loss worth ~1% of revenue.
- **KPI Strategy:** Partnered with business leaders to define actionable, business-specific KPIs.
- **Advanced Analytics:** Delivered initiatives on customer behavior, margin improvement, and growth strategy.
- **Operational Delivery:** Oversaw pipelines, workload, and reporting to ensure value delivery

Nexus Brands Group, Ballymoney — *European Data Scientist*

April 2023 - Jan 2025

Transformed the European data function (5 businesses across tattoo, beauty, and pet grooming) from fragmented, manual processes to a unified data warehouse and automated reporting framework.

- **Data Infrastructure:** Designed and implemented a centralized data warehouse consolidating multiple sources & writing all ETL pipelines..
- **Advanced Analytics:** Delivered customer-behavior projects driving improvements in marketing, sales, and operations.
- **Stakeholder Engagement:** Aligned analytics delivery with business goals, embedding a data-driven culture.

Christies Direct, Ballymoney — *Data Scientist*

May 2022- April 2023

Established the company's first Data Science function, unifying fragmented datasets into a cohesive reporting structure and enabling data-driven decision-making across the business.

- **Function Building:** Created foundational data infrastructure and reporting for Christies Direct and sister company Transgroom.
- **Cross-Business Reporting:** Integrated distinct datasets to enable direct comparison

SKILLS

Data Leadership & Strategy:

Experienced in building and leading high-performing data teams, and in establishing new data functions from scratch across multiple businesses.

Data Architecture &

Engineering: Strong background in designing and implementing data warehouses, ETL pipelines, and reporting frameworks to unify fragmented systems.

Programming & Tools: 8+ years in Python (Pandas, Polars, NumPy, SciPy), SQL, and IDL; proficient in Git/version control and workflow automation.

Analytics & Visualization: 8+ years of experience in analysis, forecasting, visualization, KPI design, and advanced analytics, including building self-service dashboards with Streamlit and BI tools.

Communication & Stakeholder

Engagement: Skilled in executive presentations, technical writing, and cross-functional collaboration with industrial and business leaders.

Numerical & Problem-Solving

Expertise: Exceptional quantitative skills with proven ability to translate complex data into actionable business insights.

across businesses.

- **Stakeholder Engagement:** Partnered with teams at all levels to embed analytics into daily decision-making.
- **Career Progression:** Success in this role led to promotion as European Data Scientist at the parent company the Nexus Brands Group.

Queen's University Belfast, Belfast — *Research Fellow*

January 2022- April 2022

- Refined bespoke **image feature recognition software** for Randox Laboratories.
- Developed IDL code to support new biochip designs in collaboration with biomedical teams.
- Produced technical documentation and presentations for industrial stakeholders.

EDUCATION

Queen's University Belfast, Belfast — *Physics PhD*

September 2017- February 2022

- Research: "*Observations and Modelling of Intensity Time Series for Biomedical and Astrophysical Applications.*"
- Developed statistical algorithms to detect signals **below the noise floor**, leading to **novel discoveries of stellar nanoflares**.
- Applied the same methods to biomedical data, creating **noise suppression and dynamic range software**.
- Built image recognition software reducing downstream processing time by **98.8%** (600s → 7s) for Randox.
- Published and presented widely; collaborated across academia and industry.
- Core tools: **Python, IDL, statistical modelling, large-scale data analysis**.

Queen's University Belfast, Belfast — *Physics MSci*

September 2013 - June 2017

- Achieved First Class Honours.
- Developed strong **analytical, numeracy, and IT skills** through rigorous coursework and research.
- Built collaboration, presentation, and teamwork skills via group projects and lab work.